

TAILBOARD TALK 2.0

Pre-Job Briefing Checklist for a Modernizing Grid

Ambiguity = Fatality. Run every step, every job.

1. CLEARANCE

Confirm isolation and clearance tag with the system operator via the request-confirm-release chain before any contact.

2. HAZARDS

Review job-specific hazards with the full crew.

3. PROTECTIVE MEASURES

Confirm grounding, PPE, and any additional protective equipment required for this job.

4. ROLES

Confirm each person's role and responsibility for the job.

5. NEW: MODERNIZATION CHECK

- ☐ Could this circuit be re-energized by an automated or remotely operated switching device (e.g., an automated recloser)? If yes, confirm the device is in manual lockout, not simply open.
- ☐ Are there distributed energy resources connected to this circuit (rooftop solar, battery storage, other customer-owned generation)? If yes, confirm all relevant disconnects are verified open, not assumed.

If either answer is uncertain, treat the circuit as live until the system operator confirms otherwise.

General reference: Occupational Health and Safety Act (Ontario); IHSA safe-practice guidelines. Illustrative job aid designed by Jordan Smith as an instructional design portfolio piece.